1951

F
FAR EASTERN DEPARTMENT

JAPAN

FJ 1022/21

97

FROM

Foreign Office Minute
Mr. Johnston C.P. Scott.

No. 1

Dated 15th January 1951

Received in Registry— 20th January 1951.

Japanese Peace Treaty: purpose of Mr. Dulles visit to Japan to discover whether the general strategy of the Pacific can be based on a policy of co-operation with Japan.

REFERENCES

FJ 1021/236. } – 1950
FJ 1021/235. }
FJ 1021/232 G – 1950.
FJ 1022/4G } – 1951
FJ 1022/16G }
FJ 1022/20.

MINUTES

See within

(Print)

(How disposed of)

(Action completed) 24/1

(Index) 20/6/51

39451

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Minutes.

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FJ 1022/21

FJ1021/235

Flags F, E, D

FJ1021/236

The Department's three papers on the Japanese Peace Treaty (C.P.(50)318, 322 and 323) have been approved by Ministers, and the Commonwealth Prime Ministers' Conference has discussed a paper (C.P.M.(51)5) based upon those papers. The Prime Ministers were all agreed on the importance of an early Peace Treaty with Japan.

FJ1021/232G.

B FJ1022/4G 1951

A FJ1022/16G 1951.

2. The United States Government (see Washington saving telegrams Nos. 858 of the 20th December and 881 of the 28th December, 1950, and No. 129 of the 12th January) have now decided, after some three months of indecision, to try to obtain a Peace Treaty (as opposed to some other form which would end the state of war with Japan) as soon as they can. Mr. Dulles is to go to Japan on the 22nd January for a stay of a fortnight during which he has undertaken to see Sir A. Gascoigne. The purpose of Mr. Dulles' visit is "to ascertain whether the general strategy of the Pacific can be based on a policy of cooperation with Japan," and also to discover

(a) to what extent Japan will be able and willing to assume the burden of her own defence,

(b) the mood of the Japanese,

(c) the application and effects of the present Japanese Constitution.

Mr. Dulles has also informed Sir O. Franks that the U.S. Government has no intention of discussing these Treaty proceedings with the Chinese Communists.

NOTHING TO BE WRITTEN IN THIS MARGIN.

A

⊕ (see Washington sav tel 129 of 12th January)

3. I submit that, now that the U.S. Government have decided to try to secure a Peace Treaty, and have given us a memorandum ⊕ expanding Mr. Dulles' original seven points, we should, if possible, make our own views, based on the Cabinet papers referred to above, known to the Americans informally as soon as possible. If we do not do so, we run the risk of being unable to influence American thinking.

4. I suggest that our views might best be conveyed to Mr. Dulles by Sir A. Gascoigne at Tokyo. In order that he should do this it will be necessary to obtain the agreement of Commonwealth Governments to our giving the Americans a purely United Kingdom view before they have had time to comment on the paper circulated to the Commonwealth Prime Ministers' Conference. I think that we should try to obtain this agreement, pointing out that the balance of advantage lies in our

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saying something to the Americans before they become committed to a policy. This may well happen once Mr. Dulles returns from Japan.

5. If the above is accepted, I will submit the necessary drafts.

~~(O.P.~~ Scott)
15th January, 1951.

Mr. C.H. Johnston.

I agree.

Please draft for submission to Mr. R.H. Scott.

C.H. Schuster
15.i.

2 drafts (telegrams in view of urgency) submitted.

(C.P. Scott).

P.U.S.A. 15/i

~~American Dept~~

China Dept.

15/1

In a personal letter of the 1st January to Mr. R.H. Scott, Sir E. Dening wrote: "I suppose that . . . we could say to the U.S., not publicly but behind the scenes, that the Potsdam Agreements were not intended to last for eternity and that in our view the time is past when there should be a Supreme Commander for the Allied Powers in Japan and that if the conclusion of a treaty is to be indefinitely delayed for reasons for which we are not responsible, we should prefer a set-up akin to that in Germany and that the right of direct contact with the Japanese should no longer remain vested solely in SCAP."

Flag G

In a minute on Sir E. Dening's letter, dated the 10th January, Sir P. Dixon wrote that we ought seriously to consider action on these lines if the Americans continue to hold out against the Japanese treaty. Sir /W. Strang

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W. Strang agreed with this view, on the 11th January. These minutes were written before the receipt of Washington telegram No. 129 of the 12th January, which suggests that the Americans have in fact now provisionally decided in favour of a peace treaty. Sir E. Dening's suggestion would encounter formal difficulties, notably in so far as it would require the alteration of an arrangement originally agreed to by the Soviet Union and China, and to put it into effect would be bound to take a time. Nevertheless, if our hopes about the prospects of an early treaty are not borne out, we shall have to consider this, and we are accordingly seeking the views of the Legal Adviser on the subject (on separate papers) as a preliminary step.

~~Copies of the two draft telegrams, when approved, should go to Sir E. Dening with covering letter, if possible by bag closing on the evening of the 18th January.~~

An explanatory letter ~~is being drafted~~ has been sent to Sir E. Dening, referring to the two tels., which he will see in Singapore, and enclosing a copy of the preface on the Peace Treaty (FJ1021/234), which Singapore have not had - pl. see draft tel. ("C") to Singapore explaining this.

C.H. Johnston.

(C.H. Johnston)
16th January, 1951.

I have modified the first draft, in view of FJ1022/20, now received.

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22/1.

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